URDU GATE: Built on the Swar Road leading to Jauhar University by the Jal Nigam at a cost of Rs 40 lakh in 2016. Demolished by the district administration in 2019, says it was built flouting rules





YATEEMKHANA: The Nawab of Rampur built the orphanage in 1760. The SP regime handed it over to the Jauhar Trust in 2016, construction of the Rampur Public School started that year

UNIVERSITY MAIN GATE: A 2.5-km-long PWD-built road runs from Singankheda village of Rampur to Kosi river dam. The Jauhar University installed a gate on the road and closed it for the general public. In 2019, the SDM court declared the gate illegal. The case is in the HC now

PANDAL: In 2015, the state cultural department constructed a grand pandal inside the Jauhar Univ. campus at a cost of Rs 12 crore. The Yogi government has ordered an inquiry



GOVT MURTAZA HIGHER SECONDARY SCHOOL: The oldest school in Rampur had the office of the district inspector of schools running in a corner. In February 2007, it was leased to the Jauhar Trust where an SP party office was opened. The administration now wants to revoke the lease of the school



RAZA ORIENTAL COLLEGE: A prestigious institution for Arabic-Persian studies, it was leased against the rules to the Jauhar Trust in 2014 after which a Rampur Public School (Extn) was opened there. Rare manuscripts stolen from Raza College were recovered from Jauhar Univ. in '22

CIRCUIT HOUSE: Constructed at a corner of the Jauhar University at a cost of Rs 5 crore, it became part of the grounds. The boundary wall is down, the administration has taken back Circuit House

HUMSAFAR RESORT: Constructed in 2015 in Pasiapura Shumali, it is run by Azam's wife Tanjeem Fatima. In August 2020, the Rampur Development Authority ordered its demolition alleging it was on public land. The case is in the HC now

STAYING THE COURSE

Azam Khan has had a colourful political journey, starting in 1966 in Class XI when he led an 'Angrezi Hatao' strike in Sunderlal Inter College, Rampur

- At Aligarh Muslim University (AMU), takes part in the **1968** agitation to restore the univ's minority status
- Elected secretary of the AMU students' union in **1975**; imprisoned in Aligarh Jail during the Emergency
- Contests elections for the first time from Rampur (Sadar) assembly with Muslim Majlis Party's backing. Manages to get over 30,000 votes
- Joins the Janata Party (Charan Singh) floated by the late PM. Elected MLA for the first time from Rampur-Sadar seat in **1980**. Has won seat a record 10 times
- Meets Mulayam Singh Yadav in **1985**. Joins Lok Dal (B) with him in 1987
- Azam is a founding member of the Samajwadi Party, started in **1992**. Cabinet minister in Mulayam-led governments in 1989, 1993 and 2003
- Expelled from SP in May **2009** after a rift with party general secretary Amar Singh. Returns in December **2010** after the latter leaves the party
- In the **2012** SP regime, Azam is de facto No. 2 with important portfolios like urban development
- In **2019**, becomes MP from Rampur LS seat. Legal troubles escalate soon after

ening. Close aides such as Fasahat Ali Khan Shanu have jumped ship and joined the BJP while many others openly claim that they had refrained from canvassing or voting in the bypolls. For all the SP's protestations, the Rampur assembly seat bypoll saw the BJP's Akash Saxena defeating Azam's candidate Asim Raja by over 34,000 votes, in a constituency with over 60 per cent Muslim votes.

But the battle is not over yet. The Azam family has filed appeals in the Rampur district judge's court against Azam and Abdullah's conviction and preparations are on for the byelection in the Swar assembly constituency, which the latter had to vacate. This will be the third byelection in district Rampur in the past one year. It will be a crucial election for Azam Khan—a win will show the naysayers that he remains top dog in Rampur, while a loss could push him further into the margins. ■